

A trading helper that knows when to say no.

An AI is allowed to have ideas. Fixed rules decide how much to bet, when to get out, and when to do nothing, and Alpaca's official command line tool places every order. Practice account PA371G5THNUO, \$100,000 start. This page describes the code that is running today.

WHO IT IS FOR, AND WHY

Everyday options traders, the people trading on a phone after work. They are now up to 60% of same-day S&P 500 option volume (Cboe, 2025), and as a group they lost \$2.1 billion in twenty months, most of it to the cost of trading rather than bad picks (Journal of Finance, 2023). Behavior research finds the same pattern after a losing streak: bet bigger, trade more. The problem is not picking stocks. It is size, exits, and knowing when to do nothing. Wingspan does exactly those three things, and nothing else.

ENGINE ONE · A SMALL, CAPPED BET

Every morning the AI reads six weeks of prices for thirteen well-known stocks and answers one question per stock: is there a bet here, and how sure am I. It cannot pick a size, a price, or an exit, and it cannot place an order.

The rules turn a yes into a bet with a fixed worst case: sell a contract five to six weeks out at a price the stock probably will not reach and collect a fee, then buy a second contract behind it so the most you can lose is set before the order goes out. Five checks follow. Sure enough (70% or more). Not already in this stock, three bets at most. Never more than \$3,000 at risk. Far enough from today's price. And cheap enough to get out of: the fee must be at least ten cents, and the cost to undo the bet on the same prices must be under one and a half times the fee, so the exit rule cannot fire the moment the bet opens.

The order goes out as one order for both contracts. Only what actually filled is recorded; the rest is cancelled.

Getting out is a separate program with no AI, every twenty minutes: take the win at half the fee, cut the loss at double the fee (only after 10 am and only when two checks in a row agree), and never hold into the last three weeks. A bet is marked closed only when the exit order actually fills.

ENGINE TWO · SHARES, NO AI

It watches the two biggest index funds, SPY and QQQ. If the price runs too far too fast in the first forty five minutes, at 10:15 it bets on a pullback. If the market opened with a jump of more than 0.8%, at 1 pm it goes with the jump. Two rules, found in six months of minute by minute data and frozen on August 28. Each trade is \$20,000, out at a 0.7% loss or after two hours, two trades a day, everything closed by 3:50 pm, and it stops for the day after losing \$300.

ALPACA

Account, positions, the market clock and every order run through Alpaca's official command line tool inside the container, pinned to a checked release. Each call is written to a log with whether it worked and how long it took. A lost reply is looked up by our own order id before it is called a failure. If the tool fails, no new bet opens; the one exception is engine two's 3:50 close, which may fall back to the software library and says so in the log. Prices come from separate read only data feeds. It runs on Railway on a schedule, and the public dashboard draws its limits page from the same functions the bot calls.

CHECKED BEFORE THE FIRST BET

We replayed the September 1 option prices. Eight of the twenty three bets the old rules would have made were losers the moment they opened. Two fixes: choose the pair that is cheapest to get out of, and refuse anything that still is not. Result: fifteen bets allowed, zero losers on arrival. On September 2 the live rules rejected both of the AI's ideas for exactly that reason, and the fix shipped the same morning. 280 automated tests.

NUMBERS, STRAIGHT FROM THE ACCOUNT · WED SEP 02, 11:23 ET

ACCOUNT VALUE

\$99,733.72

COMPLETED ORDERS IN THE WINDOW

9 · 2 option bets

MOST AT RISK PER BET

\$3,000

Disclosure. The base code predates the event (July 2026). Built inside the window: engine two and its study, the Railway deployment, the DeepSeek AI, the dashboard rework, the command line transport, and the open gate with its cap and last check. The account was created August 30; nothing else has traded on it. Two days on a practice account is not a track record; what can be verified today is the behavior.